

Διονύσιος ὁ Θραῦξ Τέχνη Γραμματική ὑπόμνησις Commentary Traditions on Dionysius Thrax

eul_aid: lvi

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Γραμματική [Grammar](#)
Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

Dionysius Thrax was a Greek grammarian who lived and worked during the 2nd century BCE. He was a student of the famous Alexandrian scholar Aristarchus of Samothrace, which placed him at the heart of the Hellenistic world's leading center for literary scholarship. His epithet "Thrax" indicates he was from Thrace, though his specific hometown is unknown. After political unrest in Alexandria, he is reported to have taught later in his life on the island of Rhodes.

His lasting importance rests on a single surviving work attributed to him, the *Tekhnē Grammatikē*, or The Art of Grammar. This concise manual is considered the first systematic grammar of any language in the Western tradition. It defines the study of grammar and outlines its components, with its most influential section establishing the eight parts of speech: noun, verb, participle, article, pronoun, preposition, adverb, and conjunction.

While some modern scholars have debated the authenticity of parts of the text as it survives, its historical impact is unquestioned. The framework of the *Tekhnē* became the foundational model for Roman, medieval, and Renaissance grammar, shaping the study of language in Europe for centuries. Numerous other scholarly works on poetry and dialects were attributed to him in antiquity, but these are now lost.

Works (7)

- Μικρὸν Βυζαντινὸν Ὑπόμνημα · [Byzantine Little Commentary](#) · 22 passages
- Ὑπόμνημα · [Commentary on Dionysius Thrax \(Recension A\)](#) · 58 passages
- Ὑπόμνημα · [Commentary on Dionysius Thrax \(Recension B\)](#) · 40 passages
- Σχόλια Λονδινά · [London Scholia](#) · 125 passages
- Σχόλια Μαρκιανά · [Marcian Scholia](#) · 151 passages
- Προλεγόμενα Βοσσιανά · [Prolegomena Vossiana](#) · 10 passages
- Σχόλια Βατικανά · [Vatican Scholia](#) · 188 passages